
Handling Cyberbullying

Targeted harassment: protecting yourself and acting

4 psychology approaches · by EvaTalk

TO BEGIN

Targeted harassment: protecting yourself and acting

Cyberbullying isn't just a 'hater': it's targeted, repeated harassment, sometimes with threats. It's serious, often illegal, and you don't have to endure it alone.

This guide helps you recognize it, protect yourself, and act — document, report, seek help.

YOUR INTENTION

What you're experiencing right now (type of messages, frequency, threats): _____

Telling cyberbullying apart

Cyberbullying differs from ordinary criticism: it's targeted, repeated, intentional, and can include threats, intimidation, doxxing. It's not 'part of the job': it's serious behavior, often punishable by law.

Naming it for what it is is the first step to acting.

Example

Sami minimized it as 'part of the job'; recognizing it as harassment made him decide to act.

Name it

Is what you're enduring targeted, repeated, with threats?

Not 'the game'

Write: 'Cyberbullying isn't part of the job: it's serious.'

Takeaway — Cyberbullying (targeted, repeated, threatening) is serious — not 'the game'.

'I must take it'

'I must take it, it's the price of visibility', 'it's my fault', 'if I complain, I look weak': these thoughts push you to endure instead of protecting yourself.

Reframing them lets you act and ask for help.

Example

'If I'm visible, I must accept it all' silenced Léa, until she understood she had the right to act.

Spot the resignation

Note a thought pushing you to endure · a fairer version.

The right to act

Write: 'I don't have to endure: I have the right to protect myself.'

Takeaway — You don't have to 'take it': you have the right to protect yourself and act.

It's not your fault

Enduring harassment is never deserved, whatever you post. Your safety and peace matter more than any content. Asking for help isn't weakness — it's respecting yourself.

You have the right to feel safe, online as anywhere.

Example

By no longer believing herself responsible, Nia could seek support without shame.

My safety

What would help you feel safer, right now?

Not my fault

Write: 'Harassment is never my fault.'

Takeaway — Harassment is never deserved — it's not your fault.

Document, report, seek help

In practice, concrete actions: document everything (screenshots, dates, links — that's your proof); report to platforms and block; don't feed the exchange; surround yourself (loved ones, other creators); and in case of threats, doxxing or illegal content, turn to legal recourse or authorities. You don't have to handle this alone.

Document + report + seek help: that's the steadiest path.

Example

By documenting everything and reporting to platforms then authorities over threats, Karim regained control.

My actions

Your first concrete action (document, report, contact help): _____

Ask for help

Write: 'I document, I report, and I ask for help.'

Takeaway — Document, report, block, and seek help (loved ones, platforms, recourse).

Key takeaways

- Cyberbullying (targeted, repeated, threatening) is serious — not 'the game'.
- You don't have to 'take it': you have the right to act.
- Harassment is never deserved — it's not your fault.
- Document everything (screenshots, dates, links): that's your proof.
- Report to platforms, block, don't feed the exchange.
- If threats: legal recourse or authorities. Ask for help.

Your turn

What I endure

Targeted, repeated, threatening?	The thought pushing me to endure

My actions

What would protect me	My first concrete action

YOUR JOURNEY

Your 4-week plan

Week 1

Recognize and name cyberbullying.

Week 2

Reframe 'I must take it'.

Week 3

Remember it's not my fault.

Week 4

Document, report, ask for help.

YOUR PLAN

Your action plan

My 'it's not my fault' line:

My first concrete action:

The help I'll seek:

You don't have to endure alone: document, report, and get help.

This guide is a psychoeducation tool, not legal advice. Cyberbullying is serious and often illegal: document, report, and seek help (loved ones, platforms, and legal recourse or authorities if there are threats). You don't have to endure this alone. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.